

WHAT IS KANBAN?



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FACTORIES CAN BE LARGE AND SPREAD OUT

SUPPLIERS OF PARTS ARE GENERALLY A DISTANCE AWAY

TAIICHI OHNO LOOKED FOR A WAY TO SIGNAL THAT THE ASSEMBLY LINE HAD USED THE PARTS AND NEEDED MORE



CARDS



EMPTY BINS



EMPTY CARTS

THIS IS CALLED "KANBAN"

WHAT IS KANBAN?

“KANBAN” MEANS SIGN, SIGNBOARD, DOORPLATE, POSTER, BILLBOARD, CARD...

AS A SIGNAL FOR SOME KIND

SEND BACK AN EMPTY BIN – A KANBAN – AND IT IS A SIGNAL TO REFILL IT WITH A SPECIFIC NUMBER OF PARTS

AN EMPTY BIN WITH A KANBAN CARD IS THE SIGNAL FOR PRODUCTION TO PULL MATERIAL

THE KANBAN QUANTIFY IS MATHEMATICALLY CALCULATED AND FINE-TUNED DURING PRACTICAL IMPLEMENTATION

WHY USE KANBAN?

A SYSTEM IS BEST CONTROLLED WHEN THE FLOW OF THE PROCESS IS SMOOTH AND RATIONAL

IF PROCESS RAW MATERIAL ARRIVE BEFORE – LEADS TO UNNECESSARY CONFUSION, INVENTORY & COSTS OCCUR

IF PROCESS OUTPUTS ARE NOT SYNCHRONIZED WITH DOWNSTREAM PROCESSES – LEADS TO DELAYS, DISAPPOINTED CUSTOMERS, AND ASSOCIATED COSTS

A PROPERLY ADMINISTERED KANBAN SYSTEM WILL IMPROVE SYSTEM CONTROL BY ASSURING TIMELY MOVEMENT OF PRODUCTS AND INFORMATION

WHEN TO USE KANBAN?

IT IS IMPORTANT THAT OTHER FUNDAMENTALS OF LEAN ARE PUT IN PLACE BEFORE VENTURING INTO KANBAN

IF NOT, FREQUENT EQUIPMENT FAILURE AND UNSTABLE OR INCONSISTENT PROCESSES WILL DEFEAT THE PURPOSE OF KANBAN